

FAMISHED CHINESE IMPERIL LINDBERGH; HE ESCAPES IN PLANE

**Craft Rushed by Mob in Flooded
City to Which Flier Took
Medical Supplies.**

TAKE-OFF MADE QUICKLY

**Vaccines Seized by Natives,
Expecting Food—Heart-
rending, Aviator Says.**

TRIP MADE WITH DOCTORS

**Followed Presentation of First
Chinese Aviation Medal to Flier
by Chiang Kai-shek.**

By HALLETT ABEND.

Wireless to THE NEW YORK TIMES.

NANKING, Sept. 26.—Colonel Charles A. Lindbergh has been forced to abandon his projected errands of mercy toward China's millions of flood sufferers, for this afternoon thousands of famished persons in the city of Hinghwa, in Northern Kiangsu Province, east of the Grand Canal, almost wrecked his plane, believing he brought food supplies.

When the plane landed on the water outside of the ancient walls of Hinghwa it was immediately surrounded by hundreds of sampans and junks, the occupants clamoring for food. The crush became so great that the danger of ruining the plane was serious.

Dr. J. Heng Liu, head of the Department of Hygiene and Sanitation of the Flood Relief Commission, narrowly escaped losing his life as he boarded a sampan carrying a bundle of drugs and anti-plague vaccines, for the famished masses believed he carried food and they jumped from boat to boat, quickly sinking his sampan with their accumulated weight. Dr. Liu managed to transfer to three different sampans, each sinking under his feet, and the priceless drugs were lost.

Lindbergh Abandons Plans.

By the time the nearest sampans were convinced the plane carried no food, and understood that the boats must keep safe from the plane, additional hundreds of watercraft began pushing upon the outer rim of the circle, and it was for a time perilous in the extreme, but eventually Colonel Lindbergh was able to take to the air.

By that time, according to the flier, Dr. Liu and Dr. J. B. Grant, literally thousands of sampans were hastening toward the plane from a circle of at least two miles radius.

Colonel Lindbergh and the two doctors who took off from Lotus Lake in Nanking at 12:30 were gone three hours. They have abandoned as dangerous the proposed attempt to visit the cities of Yangchow, Taichow, Funning and Yencheng. All these cities have been surrounded by floods since Aug. 23 and 26, and only unimportant supplies of foods have arrived by junk.

Hinghwa Centre of Refugees.

Hinghwa, where Colonel Lindbergh narrowly escaped the loss of his airplane and the possible loss of his life by drowning, is a city normally of 150,000 people, but it is estimated that the population has at least been doubled by refugees.

Colonel Lindbergh late this afternoon declared that most of the people who surrounded the plane with sampans seemed to be boat-dwellers and the doctors declared they showed signs of hunger and deprivations.

Telegraph lines are still working between Nanking and Hinghwa and the magistrate advised today's proposed flight, but apparently he was

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FAMISHED CHINESE IMPERIL LINDBERGH

By HALLETT ABEND.
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totally unable even to begin to cope with the policing of the waters around the city so as to make a landing safe for the relief workers. Colonel Lindbergh this evening reluctantly admitted that today's experience has convinced him, as well as the accompanying physicians, of the folly of attempting to continue the proposed trips with doctors, vaccines and drugs, for the starving populations get so frenzied at the thought of a probable food arrival that they are entirely uncontrollable.

Colonel Lindbergh described the scene as one of the most heart-breaking yet terrifying he had ever witnessed. The attitude of the frenzied occupants of sampans—men, women and children—was entirely peaceful, he said, but they were driven to violent mobbing of the plane by long-endured hunger. When the plane took off, the people realized that no relief had arrived for them and their violent hopes quickly sank to apathy.

Today's experience sheds new light on the immense seriousness of the flood relief problem, for it is evident to the authorities that harsh policing methods will be necessary when belated food supplies arrive or they are likely to be seized immediately and consumed by uncontrollable mobs.

Gets First Chinese Air Medal.

Before he took off on this flight the aviator at a simple ceremony this morning received from the hands of General Chiang Kai-shek, acting in the capacity of President of the National Government, the first Chinese medal awarded for distinguished service in aviation.

At 9:15 A. M. four officers of Central Aviation Bureau arrived at the United States Consulate in two automobiles, in which they escorted Colonel and Mrs. Lindbergh to the government offices. The presentation of the medal took place in General Chiang's reception room, adjoining his private office. The only persons present were Colonel and Mrs. Lindbergh, General Chiang and the vice director of the Nanking Aviation Bureau.

Immediately after the presentation, which was accompanied by formal thanks on behalf of China for the

Colonel's services in flood relief work, Mme. Chiang Kai-shek entered to receive Mrs. Lindbergh. Mme. Chiang took a picture of the group, after which refreshments and champagne were served in another apartment, where other officers and officials were present. Later the Lindberghs and General and Mme. Chiang retired to a small reception room, where they talked informally for twenty minutes.

By 11:30 o'clock Colonel Lindbergh had returned to the United States Consulate, where he hastily donned his flying togs for his take-off at noon on the flight to Hinghwa. Mrs. Lindbergh did not accompany him, thus providing extra room for medical supplies.

The Lindberghs' Sunday plans are vague and they may accept informal invitations and spend the rest of the day in conferences, writing reports and amplifying their maps. Monday may see the beginning of the formal invitations and a program which is likely to last all week.